Hongmei Lin (May Lin)

Motivation and Emotion Lab, Dept of Psychology, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR
Tel: +852-62278580
Email: MayLin@link.cuhk.edu.hk | linhongmei926@gmail.com

Profile

Ph.D. candidate in Psychology at The Chinese University of Hong Kong (expected March 2026) with research expertise in aging, prosocial behavior, and social connectedness. My work is grounded in social and lifespan psychology and combines multi-method approaches—including intensive longitudinal designs (e.g., daily diary studies), experiments, surveys, focus groups, and large-scale online data—with advanced quantitative techniques such as (cross-lagged) multilevel modeling and growth modeling. I have an active publication pipeline, experience in cross-cultural and interdisciplinary research, and growing independence in project leadership and grant-supported collaboration. My current work also extends toward AI and intergenerational connection in later life, reflecting a strong capacity to adapt quickly to emerging research directions.

Research Interests

Aging and adult development; prosocial behavior; motivation and emotion; perception of aging; social connectedness; intensive longitudinal methods; digital inclusion in later life; AI and social connection.

Education

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR
Ph.D. *in Psychology, expected March 2026*
Dissertation: From Perception to Action: How Social Perceptions Shape Age-related Prosocial Behavior
Supervisor: Prof. Helene H. Fung

Peking University, Beijing, China
M.S. *in Developmental and Educational Psychology, 2021*
Thesis: Age Differences in Social Discounting and Potential Factors
Advisor: Prof. Xin Zhang

Beijing Sports University, Beijing, China
B.S. *in Applied Psychology, 2018*
Thesis: The Effect of Ego Depletion on Altruistic Behavior
Advisor: Prof. Yuan Jiang

Publications

Note. Applicant name is shown in bold. * indicates corresponding author. † indicates equal contribution / co-first authorship.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Lin, H., Lu, Y.-L., Li, L., Li, J., Zhang, X., & Fung, H. H. (2025). Selectivity in prosociality among older adults: The moderation effect of self- and other-oriented motivation. *Psychology and Aging, 40*(3), 255-264. https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000873

Fung, N. L. K., **Lin, H.**†, Zhang, H., & Fung, H. H. (2024). Variability and diversity in development: Cross-cultural perspectives. In S. Charles (Ed.), *APA handbook of adult development and aging* (Section 6). American Psychological Association.

Lin, H., Chang, Y., Chen, C., Ho, Y. W., Xi, W., Zhang, X., Fung, H. H., & Ayalon, L. (2022). Are older adults more optimistic? Evidence from China, Israel, and the United States. *The Journals of Gerontology: Series B, 77*(4), e83-e94. https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbab046

Zhang, X., & **Lin, H.** (2019). Disengagement theory. In D. Gu & M. Dupre (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of gerontology and population aging*. Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-69892-2

Manuscripts Under Review and In Preparation

Lin, H., Wirth, M., Wu, Y., Lin, Z., Fung, H. H., & Rothermund, K. (in revision). Daily perceived expectations for active aging and daily prosocial behavior: Cultural comparison between Hong Kong and Germany. Proposal accepted for the special issue on Aging in Daily Life of the *International Journal of Behavioral Development*.

Lu, Y†, **Lin, H.** †, Löckenhoff, C. E., Zhang, X., & Fung, H. H. (in revision). Culture, age, and prosociality: Social discounting and charitable giving in the U.S. and China. Proposal accepted for the special issue on Aging and Motivation of *Psychology and Aging*.

Lin, H., Wu, Y., & Fung, H. H. (in preparation). Daily AI use and social connection among older adults: Does ageism moderate who benefits most?

Lin, H., Gu, Y., & Fung, H. H. (in preparation). Public perception of prosociality on Weibo: How actor and recipient ages influence sentiment and engagement.

Lin, H., & Fung, H. H. (in preparation). Motive vs. outcome: Age differences in prosocial evaluation and response.

Grants and Research Leadership

Co-Investigator | General Research Fund (Hong Kong) | 2025/26 | HKD 962,871
Project: What shapes expectations for older adults' prosociality across cultures?

Co-Investigator | Healthy Longevity Catalyst Awards (Hong Kong) | 2024 | HKD 388,908
Project: Tales Weaver: An AI-Enhanced System to Foster Social Connectedness

Co-Investigator | Direct Grant for Research | HKD 100,000
Project: When favoring family is against public interest: Age-related differences in prioritization between pro-family and prosocial goals

Co-Investigator | CU-ASK Social Innovation Fund | HKD 200,000
Project: Reducing the Digital Divide in Later Life: Developing Social Solutions for an Age-friendly Digital World in Hong Kong

Team Leader | Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding | HKD 15,000
Project: Age Differences in Doing Good and Looking Good: The Effect of Public Perception on Older Adults' Prosociality

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Motivation and Emotion Lab, The Chinese University of Hong Kong
Supervisors: Prof. Jingjing Zhao, Prof. Fanny Cheung and Prof. Helene H. Fung
Dates: Jan. 2026 - Present

- Designing and administering survey materials for research on psychological reactions following the 2025 Tai Po Fire.
- Contributing to rapid-response data collection in a real-world applied social science context.

Research Assistant, Motivation and Emotion Lab, The Chinese University of Hong Kong
Supervisor: Prof. Helene H. Fung
Dates: Aug. 2025 - Jan. 2026

- Co-authored a funded AI for Social Connectedness proposal supported by the Healthy Longevity Catalyst Award.
- Led collaboration among behavioral scientists, engineers, and UX designers.

- Designed and managed an intensive longitudinal study (10-day daily diary design) to evaluate user engagement and intervention impact. Conducted multilevel modeling analyses to account for nested and interdependent data structures.

Selected Conference Presentations

Lin, H. , Wu, Y., Meng, H. M., & Fung, H. H. (2026). The daily interplay of ageism and AI closeness in older adults: Examining the role of performance expectancy. 14th Conference for Chinese Psychologists accepted oral presentation.

Lin, H. , Wu, Y., & Fung, H. H. (2026). The daily relationship between prosocial behavior and subjective age in older adults: A daily diary study. 23rd IAGG World Congress of Gerontology and Geriatrics, accepted poster presentation.

Lin, H. , Wu, Y., Ma, T., Meng, H. M., & Fung, H. H. (2026). The development of an age-friendly AI narratives platform to enhance intergenerational social connectedness: A focus group study. ICAP International Congress, accepted poster presentation.

Lin, H. , & Zhang, X. (2025). Mitigating age-related decline in life satisfaction: The importance of environmental protection values. IPA International Congress, oral presentation.

Lin, H. , Lin, Z., Wu, Y., & Fung, H. H. (2025). Prescriptive views of aging on prosocial behavior in older adults: The moderating role of awareness of age-related changes. APS Annual Convention, oral presentation.

Lin, H., Cheung, K. L., Wu, Y. Yue, C. S. Y., & Fung, H. (2024). Technology acceptance in late life: An intergenerational intervention program to promote older adults' digital navigation skills. The European Conference on Aging & Gerontology, poster presentation.

Teaching and Service

Teaching Assistant, Writing and Presentation, CUHK, Spring 2025

Teaching Assistant, Experimental Design, CUHK, Fall 2023 and Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant, Emotion and Motivation, CUHK, Spring 2023

Student reviewer for Innovation in Aging and Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences

Selected Honors

Postgraduate Scholarship, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2021-2025

Research Postgraduate Student Overseas Grant, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2021-2025

Outstanding Thesis Award, Peking University, 2021

China National Scholarship, 2015, 2016, 2017

Methods and Technical Skills

Research Design: Intensive longitudinal designs (daily diary studies); experiments; surveys; focus groups; cross-cultural research; social media data

Quantitative Analysis: Intensive longitudinal data analysis (e.g., multilevel modeling, mixed-effects models); Moderation and mediation analysis; Sentiment analysis

Tools: R (lme4, nlme) | SPSS | Jamovi | PsychoPy | Qualtrics | Credamo | Cursor

Emerging workflows: LLM-assisted programming; AI-related behavioral research; interdisciplinary collaboration with engineering and UX teams

Languages: Mandarin (native) | English (professional) | Cantonese (listening comprehension)